

Getting Started

DS 6015: Data Science Capstone
School of Data Science
University of Virginia

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How to Get Started - Onboarding

Complete onboarding ASAP (e.g., training, sign agreements)

It's often quick to complete

Can be a blocker to data access

How to Get Started – Understanding History

- Take inventory (tools, code, data, environment)
 - > What have they tried?
 - > What works well / does not work well?
- Understand the big picture.
 - > What is the goal?
 - > How will your work be used?

How to Get Started – Breaking things down

- Look for intermediate milestones:
 - > Forming training set / validation set
 - > Decide on metrics
 - > Coding data pipelines

How to Get Started – Breaking things down

- Thinking about functionality

- > What needs to happen? (build lists, embed objects, build classifier, ...)

- > Are there modules for the functionality?

- May not need to build things from scratch

- Can check for built-ins, papers w code, Hugging Face, ...

- What do you need to code / build?

- Break out large tasks and add to roadmap

How to Get Started – Breaking things down, contd.

- Look for techniques (NLP, time series, ...)

The type of data will help guide

Helpful approaches:

- > Literature review

Has this problem / similar problem been solved? How?